Hospital Visitor Access Policy

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1. Purpose

This document explains the hospital's approach to safe and welcoming visitor access. It was prepared after workshops with ward staff, security officers, and the patient experience team.

2. Scope

The policy covers public entrances and inpatient wards. It does not describe emergency response, clinical care, or access by hospital employees.

3. Definitions

A general visitor is a family member, friend, or other guest who is not working for the hospital. The nurse in charge is the registered nurse coordinating a ward during the relevant shift.

Hospital Visitor Access Policy

4. Requirements

4.1 General visiting hours

General visitors must leave inpatient wards by 8:00 p.m. daily, unless the nurse in charge authorizes an exception.

4.2 Visitor registration

Before allowing a general visitor beyond the security desk, Security staff must verify one government-issued photo ID and record the visitor's name, destination, and arrival time.

4.3 Visitor badges

General visitors must wear the issued visitor badge above the waist while inside the hospital and return it when leaving.

Hospital Visitor Access Policy

4. Requirements continued

4.4 Access outside general visiting hours

Outside general visiting hours, Security staff must admit only general visitors whose names appear on an after-hours authorization record approved by the nurse in charge.

4.5 Ward visitor limit

The nurse in charge must limit each inpatient to no more than two general visitors at one time when additional visitors would obstruct staff movement or routine ward operations.

5. Guidance and examples

For example, a visitor who arrives shortly before closing may be reminded of the closing time at registration. This example illustrates a common conversation and does not create an additional requirement.

The hospital previously used paper badges in several colors. That historical detail is included for context only and does not determine which badge is issued today.

Questions about this document can be sent to Hospital Operations at operations@example.test. The mailbox is monitored during normal business hours.